

Murff Scheduled To Hurl Tonight

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INDIANAPOLIS, IND., July 3.—The Wichita Braves still held their two-game lead over St. Paul in their battle for American Association All-Star Game host team honors today but Braves Manager Ben Geraghty was sending out a "help call" to Wichita.

Geraghty today said lefthander Vic Rehm who was struck on the elbow by a line drive last night as the Braves dropped a 5-1 decision to the Indianapolis Indians is lost to the Braves for at least two weeks.

"This really has upset my pitching plans for this series," the Braves manager said. "I had been counting on using (Bob) Ross in one of the games on Thursday."

Summoned From Bullpen
Ross, with only three days rest after a 7½ inning relief chore last Saturday night, had to be called from the bullpen in the second inning again last night when Rehm was struck by a liner off the bat of Jose Valdivielso.

"Rehm was struck right where he was hit two weeks ago and when you re-injure those bruised muscles and ligaments it can be . . ."

"He is out for at least two weeks and we need help," he finished.

The Braves got only one "break" last night in the opener of their four-game series with the sixth place Indians, in which they are hoping to nail down first place for July 5, and thus also win host team honors for the American Association All-Star Game on July 15.

Fourth-place Minneapolis knocked off second place St. Paul 7-6 in 11 innings at St. Paul.

But, that was small consolation for Geraghty who has one player forced to play out of position and another who is wearing metal plates on his right arm in center-field.

Out of position, of course, is utility infielder Bob Hartsfield and the metal-plate wearing center-fielder is Bob Talbot.

"Talbot shouldn't even be playing but then he goes out there," Geraghty said with combined regret and admiration.

Geraghty said his original pitching plans for the current series called for John (Red) Murff for tonight, and Carlton Willey and Ross for Thursday night's double-header.

There has been no change in the plans for Murff (3-2) pitching the second game of the series tonight and Willey for one game Thursday.

Unless help is received on quick notice, Gerry Nelson probably will be moved up to pitch one game on the Fourth of July twin-bill.

While things looked a little grim over in the Wichita dressing room last night, Indianapolis Manager Andy Cohen was happy.

It was suggested to Cohen that the Indians' first two runs (one of them officially unearned) were given to his club.

"You're not going to mention that after the three games you won on breaks last week at Wichita are you?" he chortled good-naturedly.

At his side at the time was Chuck Comiskey, vice-president of the Chicago White Sox.

Turning to Comiskey, he said: "I've got to have you around. We're getting some of the breaks."

Two of the "breaks" last night were a single to center by Chico Garcia which went through the legs of on-rushing but injured Talbot to score a walking Ted Beard from first base in the opening inning, and high fly triple to right in the third inning which out-of-position Hartsfield lost in the twilight to set up a second run.

This high-fly triple was by Beard and scored on a single by Jim Delsing.

Cohen was well-pleased with the seven-hit pitching chore of ex-New York Yankee Jim McDonald.

"He pitched us a good game; particularly good when you consider he has been out for a month," the Indianapolis manager said.

McDonald was making his first appearance since June 3. He suffered a back injury at that time.

He also was picking up his second victory in three decisions for the season and his second over Wichita.

The injured Rehm was the loser. Gametime for the second round of the series will be 6:45 o'clock, Wichita time. Pitching for Indianapolis will be Bill Dofour who has a 3-5 record.

On TV There

Tonight's game will be televised locally.